

Reverse Proxy Setup mini-FAQ

Everything you need to know about ECAS and EC reverse proxies.

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Introduction

The EC network has multiple reverse proxies handling access to web applications from different places, both inside and outside the EC network.

An application has an *internal access URL*, based on the server DNS name, and can have one or multiple *proxy URLs*.

To give an example for ECAS:

- the internal ECAS URL is <https://ecas.cc.cec.eu.int:7002/cas/login>
- <https://webgate.ec.europa.eu/cas/login> is one of the multiple ECAS proxy URLs that exist (in this case through the Webgate reverse proxy, as you might have guessed)

Q1. In my ECAS configuration, what should I use as a service URL for my application: the direct URL, or a proxy one?

Putting a proxy URL as your ECAS service URL might work, but has several shortcomings:

- you will *only* be able to access your application through that particular reverse proxy, *no direct access* to your application will work anymore
- as proxies cannot be chained, you *won't* be able to setup access to your application through a *second reverse proxy*

As such, we do recommend to **always setup your service URL as the *direct URL* to your application**. Use either the DNS name of your server or your load-balancer (if you have one).

Q2. I followed the recommendation, but my application is not accessible through proxy xxx (Webgate/Intragate/Testa...)

First make sure your application is properly configured to work with ECAS, access it through your direct server URL and check that you are properly redirected to ECAS and then back to that same direct server URL after authentication.

Then contact DIGIT SNET (Snet@ec.europa.eu) to request the setup on the reverse proxy through which you need to be accessed. Make sure to mention that your application is ECAS protected.

Q3. My application was working fine with proxy A, but now it needs to be accessed through proxy B and I can't make it work (ECAS redirects to proxy A, not B)

You didn't follow the recommendation, and you set up the ECAS service URL in your application as the Proxy A URL. As proxies cannot be chained, you won't be able to setup access to your application through a second reverse proxy.

To solve this issue:

1. Follow the recommendation and make sure your application is configured with the *direct DNS name as service URL* (see Q1)
2. Make sure ECAS authentication works when you access your application through the direct URL
3. Request from DIGIT SNET (Snet@ec.europa.eu) forward and reverse mappings for your application on all needed proxies, and mention in your request that *your application is ECAS protected*. This last bit of information is necessary, so that the SNET team can also map the *ECAS server URL* itself in the context of your application.
4. Make sure your application works through all reverse proxies

Q4. I can access my application through proxy xxx but I always lose my web session /need to re-authenticate on each request

Your cookie path is probably incorrect, maybe it's not properly rewritten by the proxy or was incorrectly setup from the start. Refer the the [Cookie Monster page](#) for details on how to debug this kind of situation.